

Standard Chartered (STAN.L/2888.HK): Key takeaways from Investor Event

Standard Chartered hosted an Investor Event on 19 May, including the presentation of new financial targets. The presentations focused on the group's "super-connector" strategy and its transition into a "compounding" phase of growth. Specifically, the group highlighted its positioning to capture opportunities from shifting trade corridors, rising wealth participation in Asia, digital transformation, and the transition economy. The share price reaction was mixed with STAN (2888 HK) closing +2.3% while STAN.L opened weaker and traded ~-1.1% lower (at the time of writing). On the positive side, medium-term targets were broadly in line with consensus, with wealth ambitions brought forward, and potential upside to consensus if revenues track toward the top end of the guided 5-7% CAGR range. That said, investor feedback has focused on the degree of conservatism embedded in medium-term guidance, in addition to the unchanged 2026 guidance, while the CIR targets leave a fairly broad range of potential cost outcomes in absolute \$ terms. All-in, while 2026-2028 ROTE guidance aligns with consensus and may not drive near-term upgrades, the 2030 ambition suggests further upside potential, with management signaling scope to outperform the stated ~18% target over time.

To us, key takeaways included:

1. **Compounding Profitability:** The group has transitioned from its "Execute" phase into a "Compound" phase, delivering 11.9% ROTE in 2025. Management is now focused on driving sustainably higher returns by leveraging its "super-connector" franchise and modernized infrastructure, targeting ROTE of >15% by 2028 and ~18% by 2030. This uplift is primarily driven by a business mix shift across Wealth & Retail Banking (WRB)—led by the affluent segment—and Corporate & Investment Banking (CIB), supported by network and Financial Institutions (FIs), contributing ~380bps of ROTE expansion. In addition, balance sheet optimisation is expected to add up to ~50bps. While ROTE remains the key return metric, management alluded to the rising importance of Economic Value Added (EVA) over time as the bank increasingly focuses on optimizing shareholder value, with ROTE vs. EVA already used as a core internal trade-off framework.
2. **Wealth Management:** STAN has accelerated its strategic timeline, bringing forward its key wealth targets by one year from 2025-29 to 2025-28 while maintaining the notional values:
 - **NNM:** \$200 billion cumulative over 2025-28E (previous 2025-29E)

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- ❑ **Wealth Income:** Double-digit three-year CAGR (2026-2028) vs. previous double-digit 5-year CAGR
- ❑ **Affluent Income:** Target to reach 75% of total WRB income by 2028E (previous 2029E)
- ❑ **Affluent Investment:** Maintain \$1.5 billion allocated for 2025-2029.

3. **Operational transformation and efficiency:** STAN's "Simple, Connected, and Fast" operating model standardises the core to drive scale and efficiency while allowing for high-value differentiation at the client interface level. Over 90% of markets are now on a single core banking platform, allowing the bank to own its source code and accelerate build, test, and deployment cycles. While further infrastructure investments remain (notably in Korea and Taiwan) to complete the rollout of their core banking platform, this should support improved efficiency over time. Beyond the ~57% CIR target by 2028, management outlined additional productivity/cost targets, including a ~20% increase in income per employee by 2028 and >15% reduction in corporate functions headcount by 2030. The "Fit for Growth" (FFG) programme also remains on track to deliver ~\$1.3bn in savings by end-2026 (1:1 spend-to-save).
4. **Capital allocation and CET1:** STAN now targets a more balanced capital allocation framework for 2026-28, with ~one-third each allocated to organic growth, dividends, and share buybacks—versus a heavier skew to buybacks (>50%) back in 2024-25. The group will operate dynamically within its guided CET1 range, targeting a long-term average at the 13.5% midpoint.

Valuation and risks

We are Buy-rated on STAN.L and 2888.HK. Our 12m price target for STAN.L of 2,260p is based on a 10.25x target P/E multiple — with our P/E valuation methodology applied 75%/25% to 2027/28E estimates. Our 12m price target for 2888.HK of HK\$243 is based on a 2-stage dividend discount model. Key downside risks include reversal/pause of positive jaws delivery, slower-than-expected non-interest income growth, lower-than-expected net interest income growth.

Disclosure Appendix

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We, Chris Hallam, Melissa Kuang, CFA, Benjamin Caven-Roberts, Sachin Nayar and Wayne Wang, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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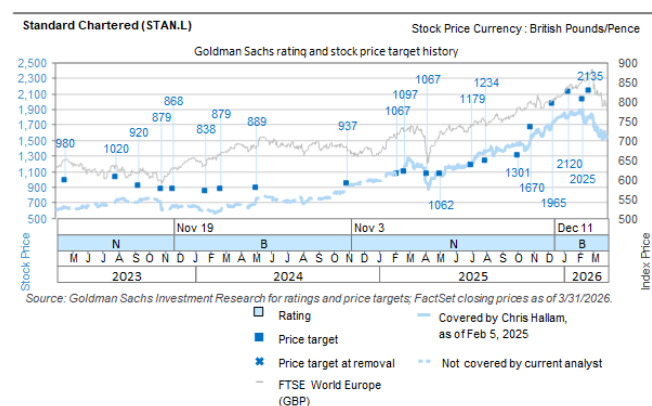
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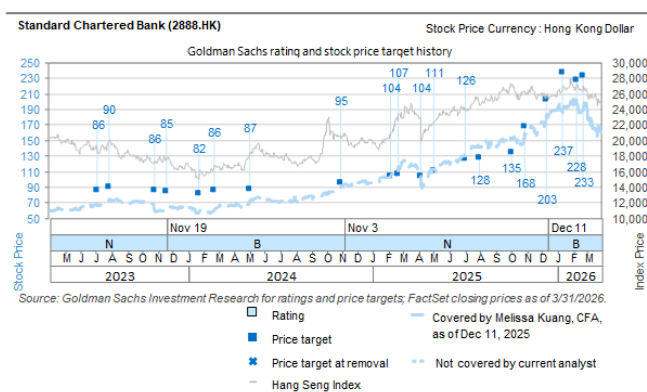
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Target price history table(s)

Standard Chartered Bank (2888.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
30-Apr-26	243.00	190.80
21-Apr-26	237.00	192.40
24-Feb-26	233.00	197.90
09-Feb-26	228.00	202.00
13-Jan-26	237.00	191.60
11-Dec-25	203.00	177.00
30-Oct-25	168.00	159.50
03-Oct-25	135.00	152.60
31-Jul-25	128.00	142.00
04-Jul-25	126.00	130.30
02-May-25	111.00	113.60
07-Apr-25	104.00	91.50
21-Feb-25	107.00	116.00
05-Feb-25	104.00	103.60
30-Oct-24	95.00	90.75
02-May-24	87.00	71.95
23-Feb-24	86.00	62.45
23-Jan-24	82.00	58.00
19-Nov-23	85.00	61.30

Standard Chartered (STAN.L)

Date of report	Target price (£)	Closing price (£)
30-Apr-26	2,260	1,862.8
21-Apr-26	2,165	1,806
24-Feb-26	2,135	1,789
09-Feb-26	2,025	1,899
13-Jan-26	2,120	1,832
11-Dec-25	1,965	1,717
30-Oct-25	1,670	1,571
03-Oct-25	1,301	1,467
31-Jul-25	1,234	1,360.5
04-Jul-25	1,179	1,207
02-May-25	1,062	1,096.5
07-Apr-25	1,067	937.2
21-Feb-25	1,097	1,183
05-Feb-25	1,067	1,074
30-Oct-24	937	912.6
02-May-24	889	756
23-Feb-24	879	635
23-Jan-24	838	605.8
19-Nov-23	868	660

Standard Chartered Bank (2888.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
26-Oct-23	86.00	59.75
28-Jul-23	90.00	74.50
06-Jul-23	86.00	66.55

Standard Chartered (STAN.L)

Date of report	Target price (£)	Closing price (£)
26-Oct-23	879	625.2
12-Sep-23	920	725.4
28-Jul-23	1,020	737.6

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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